

Alex Mercer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Backend Engineer with 5+ years of experience designing and scaling distributed systems, RESTful microservices, and asynchronous event pipelines. Expertise in Python, FastAPI, Django, PostgreSQL, and AWS cloud environments. Passionate about automated testing, performance tuning, and clean software architecture.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Languages: Python, SQL, JavaScript, Bash
- Frameworks & Tools: FastAPI, Django REST Framework, Celery, Redis, Docker, Git
- Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, MongoDB
- Cloud & DevOps: AWS (ECS, S3, RDS, Lambda), CI/CD (GitHub Actions), Linux, Nginx
- Testing: Pytest, Unit Testing, TDD, Integration Testing

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Backend Engineer | CloudScale Inc. (2022 - Present)

- Architected and deployed 12+ high-throughput microservices using Python and FastAPI, handling 15M+ daily requests with 99.98% uptime.
- Optimized PostgreSQL database queries and connection pooling, reducing p99 API latency by 42% across core billing endpoints.
- Spearheaded migration of background tasks to Celery and Redis clusters, cutting asynchronous execution times by 35%.
- Engineered automated CI/CD deployment pipelines on AWS ECS using GitHub Actions, enabling zero-downtime releases.

Backend Software Engineer | DataStream Labs (2019 - 2022)

- Developed secure RESTful APIs utilizing Django and PostgreSQL supporting 100k+ active SaaS subscribers.
- Implemented Pytest test suites achieving 88% code coverage, substantially reducing regression defects in production.
- Automated containerization workflows with Docker and configured monitoring with Prometheus and Grafana.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science | University of California, Berkeley

Graduated 2019 | Relevant Coursework: Data Structures, Algorithms, Distributed Systems